SEV-2

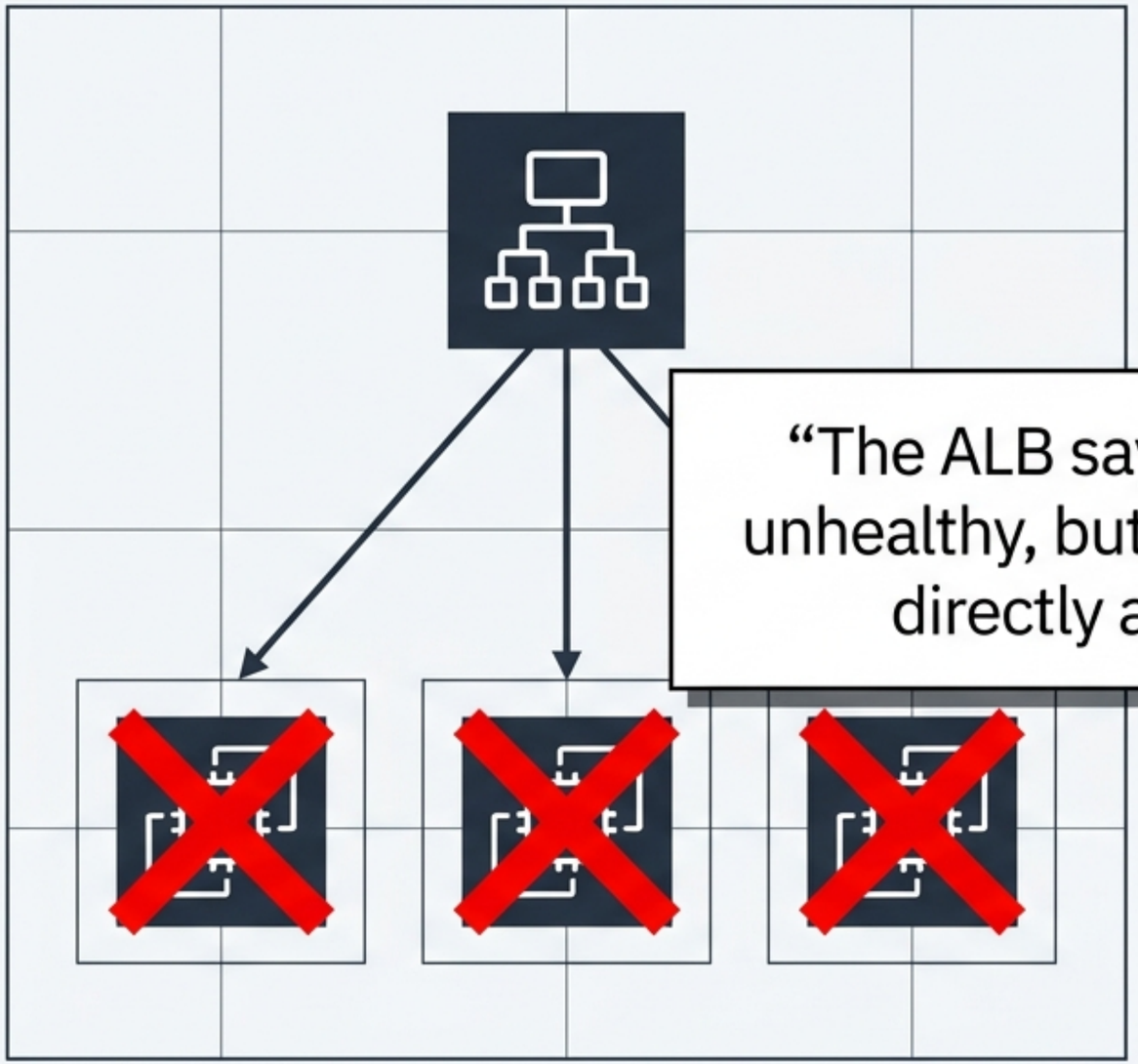
Reporter: Priya (Team Lead)
Environment: NorthBank Production

All Targets Unhealthy — but the App Is Fine

AWS Day 2 Operations & Troubleshooting:
Lab 07 Post-Incident Analysis

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ALB Status: UNHEALTHY



```
$ curl http://<target-ip>:80
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
```

"The ALB says every target is unhealthy, but I can curl the app directly and it works."

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The Symptom is a Liar. Read the Reason Code.

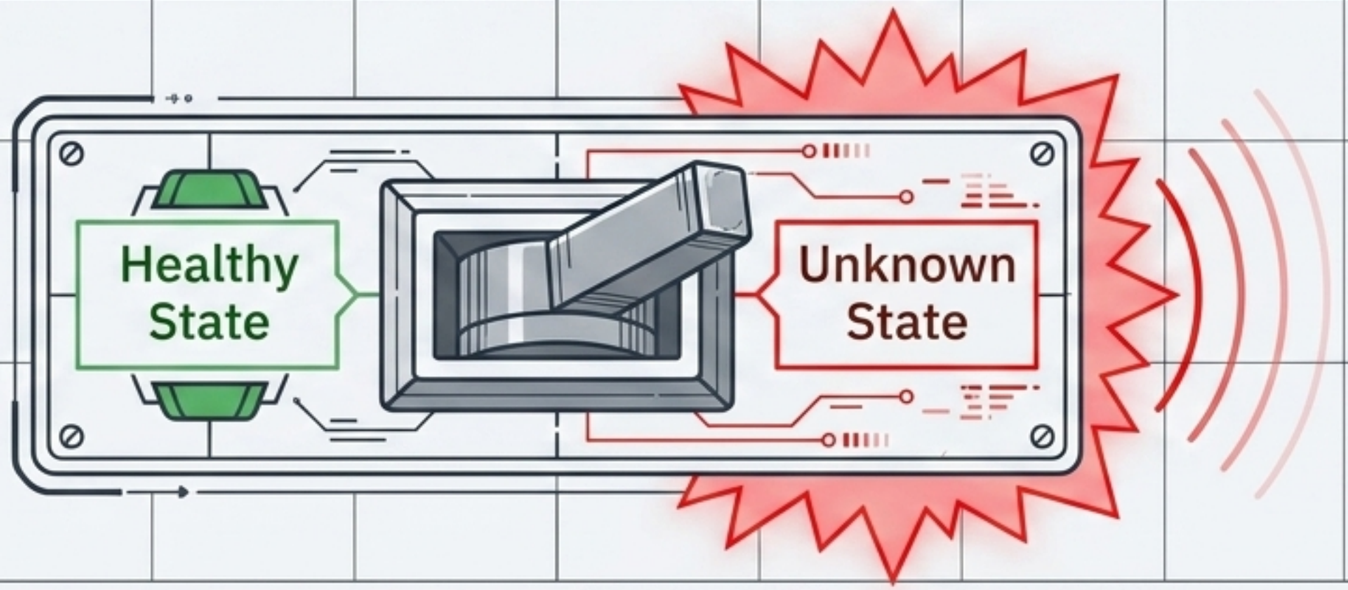
Diagnostic Bifurcation Matrix		
Diagnostic Dimension	**Network Failure**	**Config Failure**
Symptom	All Targets Unhealthy	
The Reason Code	Timeout	Target.ResponseCodeMismatch
Root Cause Category	Network / Security	App / LB Configuration
Specific Failure Point	Security Group blocking blocking port (Lab 06)	LB path doesn't match App path (Lab 07)
Resolution	Update SG rules	Update Target Group health check

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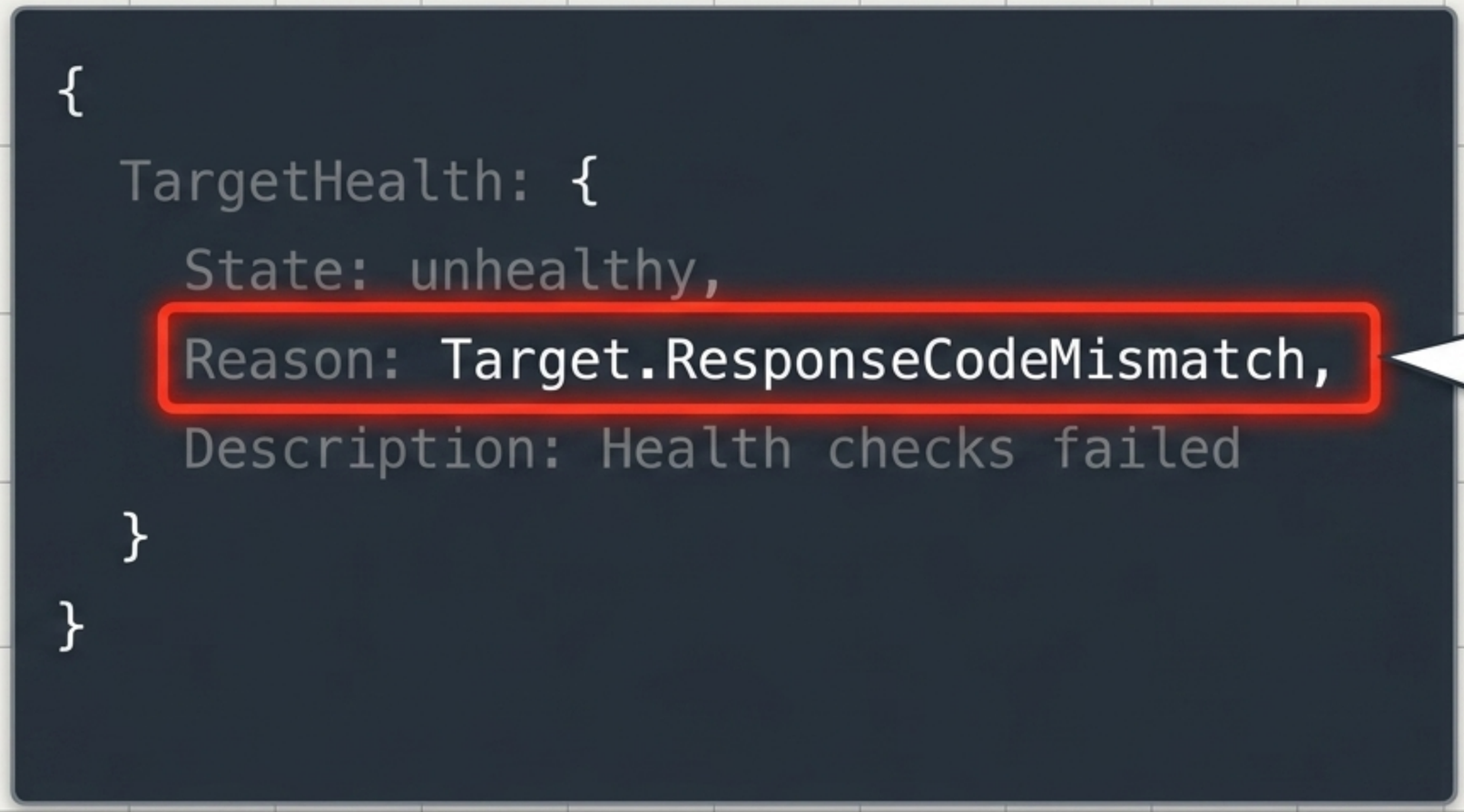
Triggering the Anomaly

```
$ export TG_ARN
# Define the target group

$ ./break.sh
# Script executes: silently mutates health check path to /healthz
```



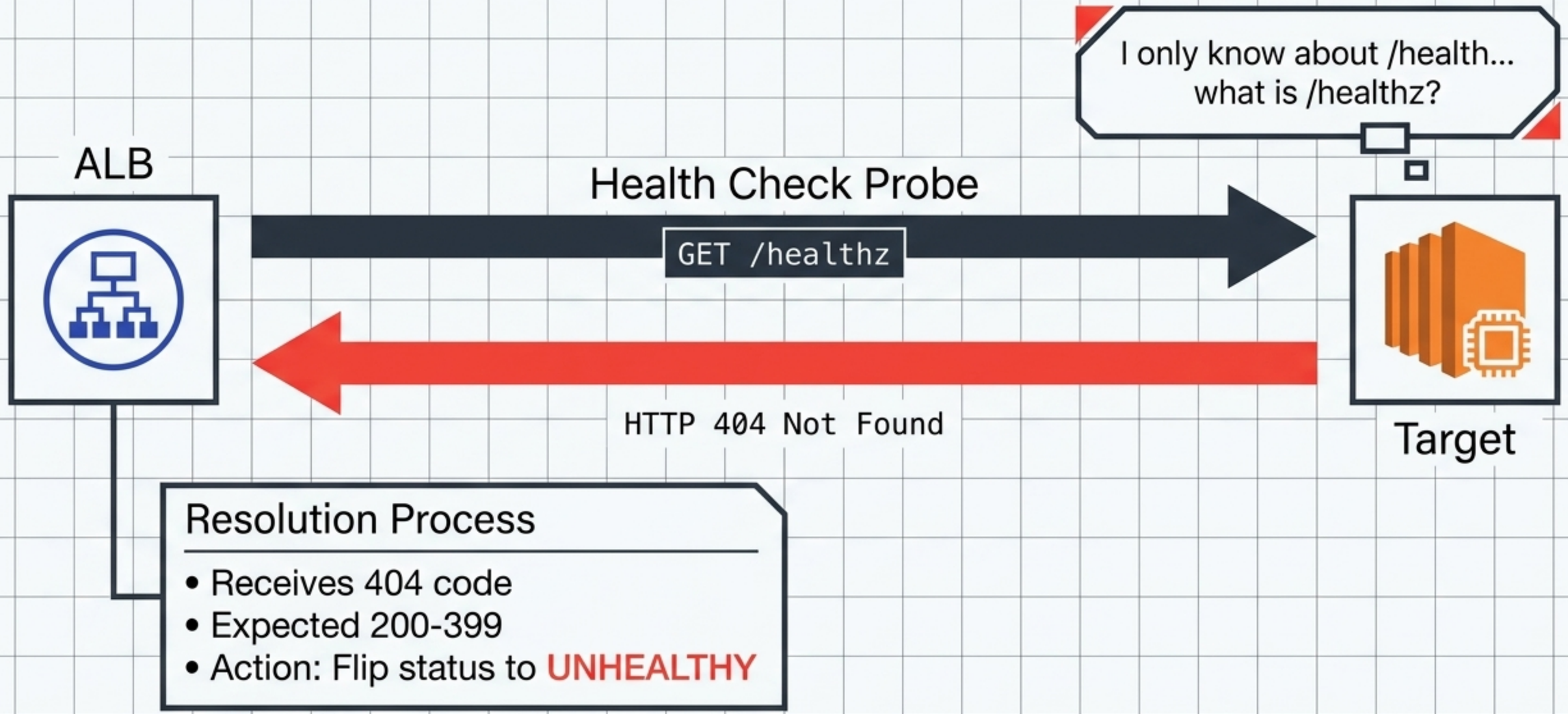
Isolating the Failure Signature



The smoking gun. The ALB can reach the target, but the target is rejecting the specific health check request.

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The Mechanics of a **Response Code Mismatch**



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Verifying the Configuration Drift

```
$ describe-target-groups

HealthCheckProtocol: HTTP,
HealthCheckPort: traffic-port,
HealthCheckPath: /healthz,
```

The `describe` command confirms the hypothesis.

The load balancer is asking for a page that doesn't exist.

A health check must fundamentally agree with the app—right path, right code.

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Aligning the Infrastructure with the Application

```
$ modify-target-group --health-check-path /health
```



Target Health: healthy

```
$ curl http://<alb-dns>
-> HTTP 200 OK
```

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The Golden Rule of Day 2 Operations

Never guess the network before reading the reason code.

The Paradox: “All targets unhealthy” can mean a blocked port OR a simple typo in a configuration path.
The Heuristic: Isolate app-vs-LB by curling the target directly.
The Reality: The reason code is the diagnosis. Treat the infrastructure and the application as a single conversational system.

NorthBank Operations Standard · Lab 07 Complete.

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